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One-Page Website Creation & Deployment using Replit

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Initial Prompt (Enhanced by Gemini):

Create a professional, single-page personal portfolio website for a student using HTML, CSS, and minimal JavaScript.

Requirements:

- Structure:
 - Sticky navigation bar with links: Home, About, Skills, Projects, Contact
 - Hero section with:
 - Full name (placeholder: "Your Name")
 - Short tagline (e.g., "Aspiring Developer / Student")
 - Call-to-action button (e.g., "View Projects")
 - About Me section with a short paragraph
 - Skills section
 - Projects section
 - Contact section

Design:

- Use a modern DARK MODE theme
- Primary accent color: neon green (#39FF14 or similar)
- Clean, minimal, and professional aesthetic
- Use consistent spacing, alignment, and typography
- Include hover transitions where appropriate

Technical:

- Fully responsive (mobile, tablet, desktop)
- Use Flexbox and/or CSS Grid for layout
- Smooth typography scaling
- No external frameworks (pure HTML/CSS/JS)

Output:

- Provide complete working code in a single file (or clearly separated HTML, CSS, JS sections)
- Use semantic HTML5 elements
- Add comments explaining key parts of the code

Refinement Prompts (at least 2 more):

Enhance the existing portfolio website with the following improvements:

Navigation & Interaction:

- Implement smooth scrolling behavior when navigation links are clicked
- Highlight the active section in the navbar while scrolling (scroll spy effect)

Skills Section:

- Convert the skills list into responsive grid cards
- Each card should include:
 - Skill name
 - Optional icon or placeholder
- Add hover effects (e.g., slight scale-up, glow, or border highlight)

Design Consistency:

- Maintain the dark mode + neon green theme
 - Ensure spacing and alignment remain clean across all screen sizes
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Further enhance the portfolio website with the following UI/UX improvements:

Projects Section:

- Convert projects into card-based layout
- Each project card should include:
 - Project title
 - Short description
 - Placeholder image box
 - Optional "View Project" button
- Add hover effects:
 - Elevation (shadow)
 - Slight zoom or glow effect
 - Smooth transition animations

Contact Section:

- Create a styled contact form with:
 - Name input field
 - Email input field
 - Message textarea
 - Submit button

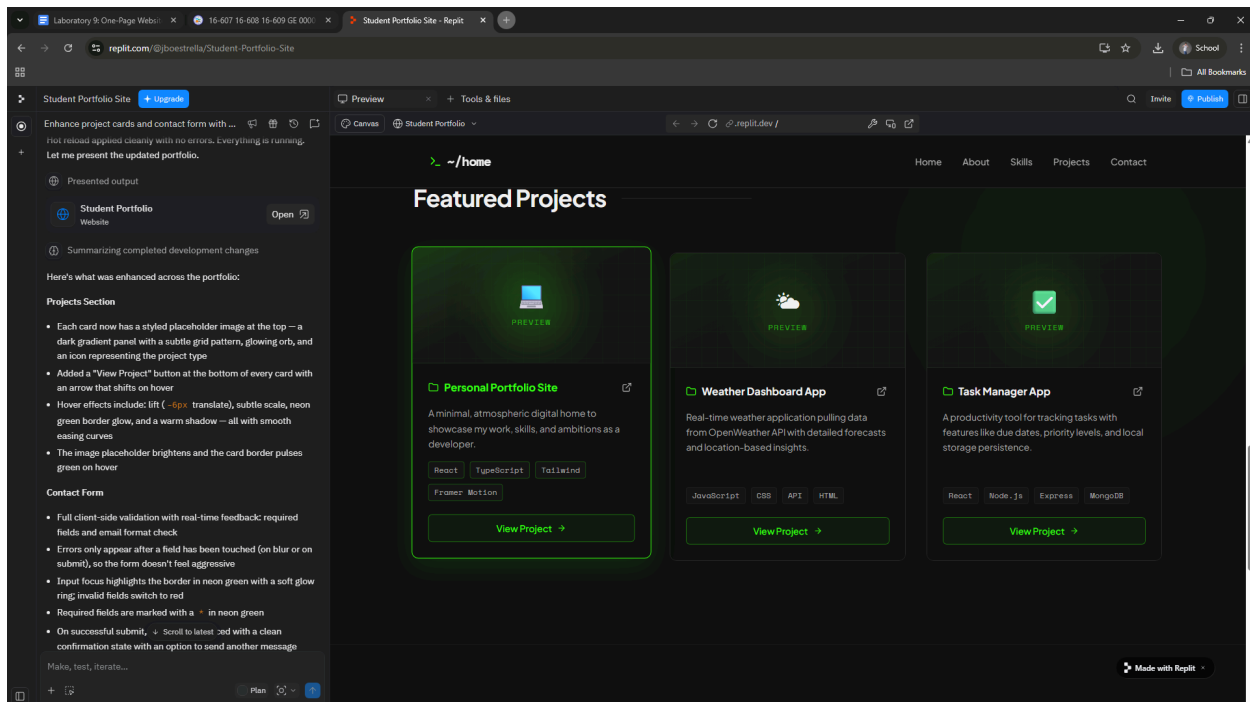
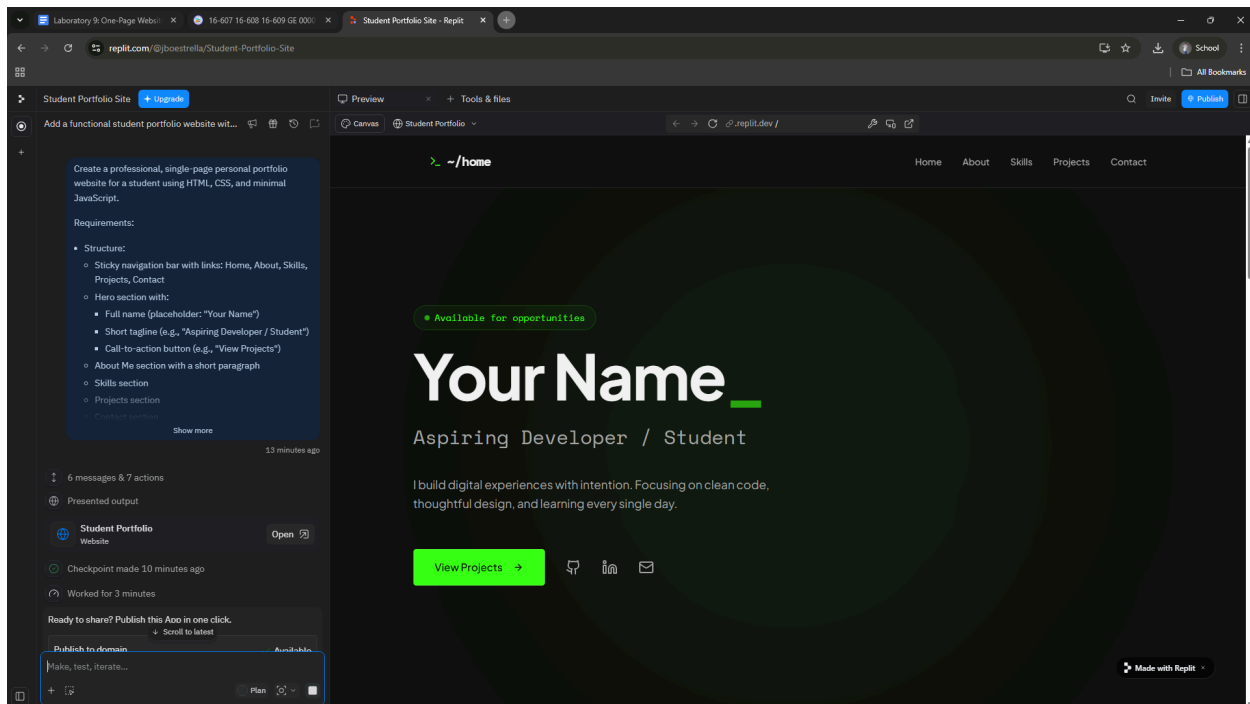
- Add:
 - Input focus effects (highlight borders in neon green)
 - Basic form validation (required fields, email format)

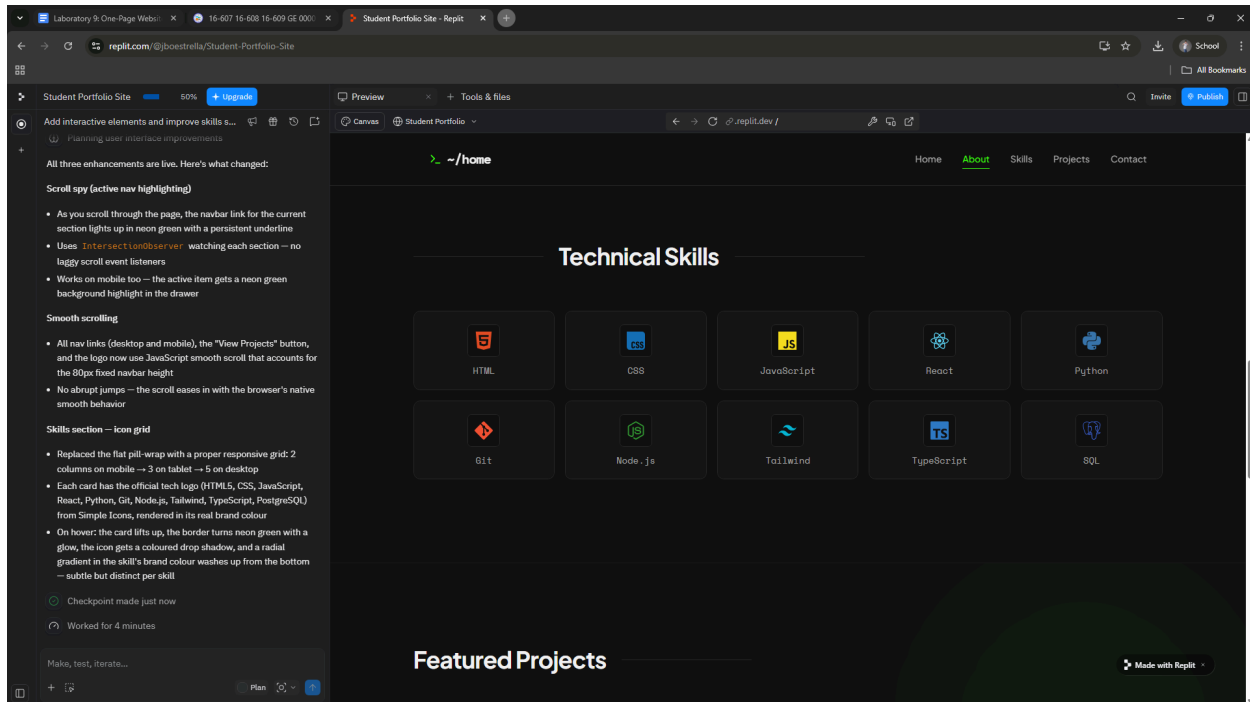
Polish:

- Ensure all animations are smooth and not excessive
- Keep the UI clean, modern, and consistent
- Maintain full responsiveness across devices

Screenshots of Outputs and Website link:

Website Link: <https://student-portfolio-site--jboestrella.replit.app>





Final Reflection:

Replit AI was excellent at generating the overall layout quickly and applying the color scheme I asked for. It was able to translate my general design instructions into a functional interface, saving a significant amount of time in setting up the initial structure. The AI also demonstrated strong capability in producing clean and organized code, which made it easier to understand and build upon. Overall, it was very efficient in handling the foundational aspects of the project, especially in terms of layout and visual consistency.

I had to manually change the text in the “About Me” section to actually describe myself instead of using the AI’s filler text. In addition, some parts of the generated content lacked personalization and required adjustments to better match my intended message and style. There were also minor issues in content accuracy and relevance, which needed to be refined to align with the purpose of the project. While the structure was solid, these small edits were necessary to make the output more meaningful and appropriate.

I learned that being specific about layout structures (like asking for a “grid” or “cards”) yields much better results than just asking for a “pretty section.” Clear and detailed prompts help guide the AI toward producing outputs that are closer to the desired outcome. I also realized that including constraints and explicit instructions—such as design elements, formatting preferences, and content expectations—greatly improves both the quality and usability of the generated result. Overall, effective prompting reduces the need for extensive revisions and leads to more precise outputs.